Sysmon Event Documentation

DG Interns Hub - Week 3 | Hands-On Task 2: Make Events and Find Them

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Overview

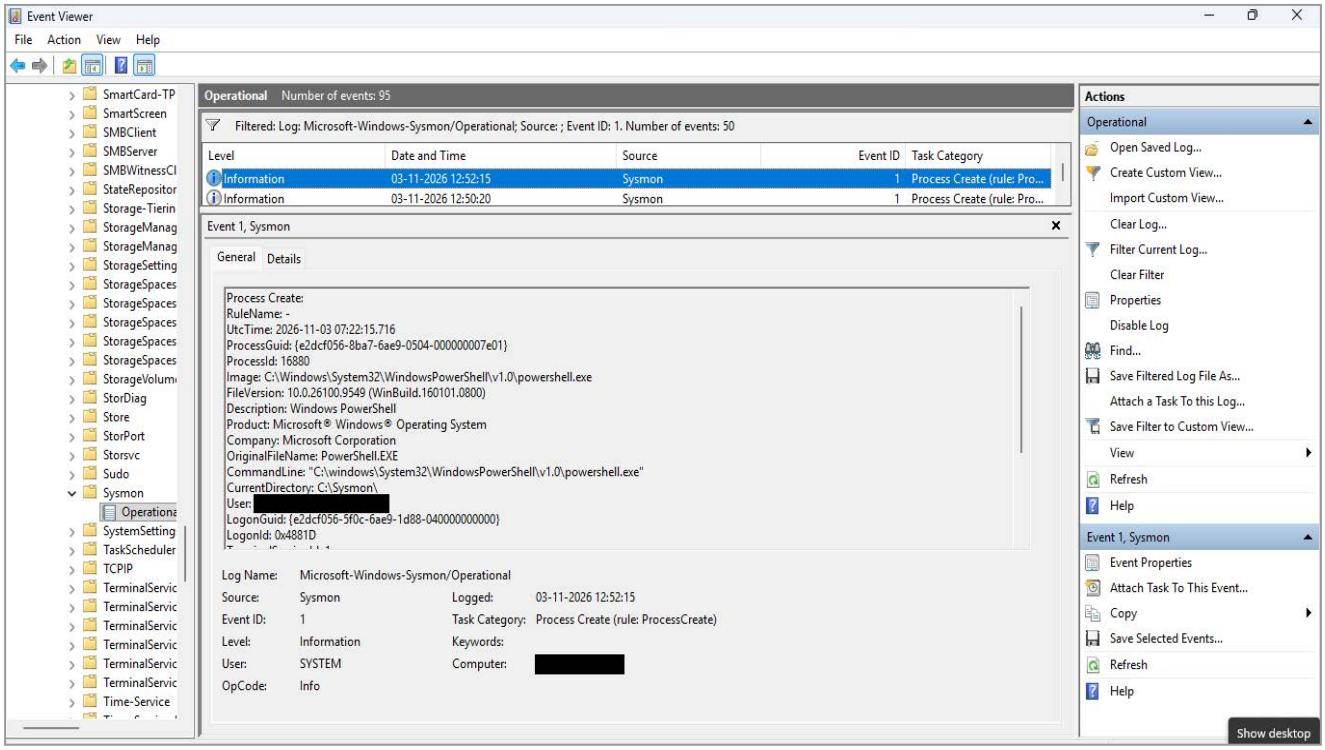
After installing Sysmon with the SwiftOnSecurity configuration, I performed four actions on my Windows 11 machine and then located the matching events in Event Viewer (Applications and Services Logs > Microsoft > Windows > Sysmon > Operational). All times are local time on 03-11-2026. I hid my username and computer name in the screenshots and wrote them as (redacted) in this document.

Summary

Action I performed	Event ID	Time	Event type
Opened PowerShell	1	12:52:15	Process Create
Created a new user account	1	12:52:35	Process Create
Checked network connections	3	12:52:52	Network Connection
Created a text file	11	12:56:46	File Create

1. Opening PowerShell

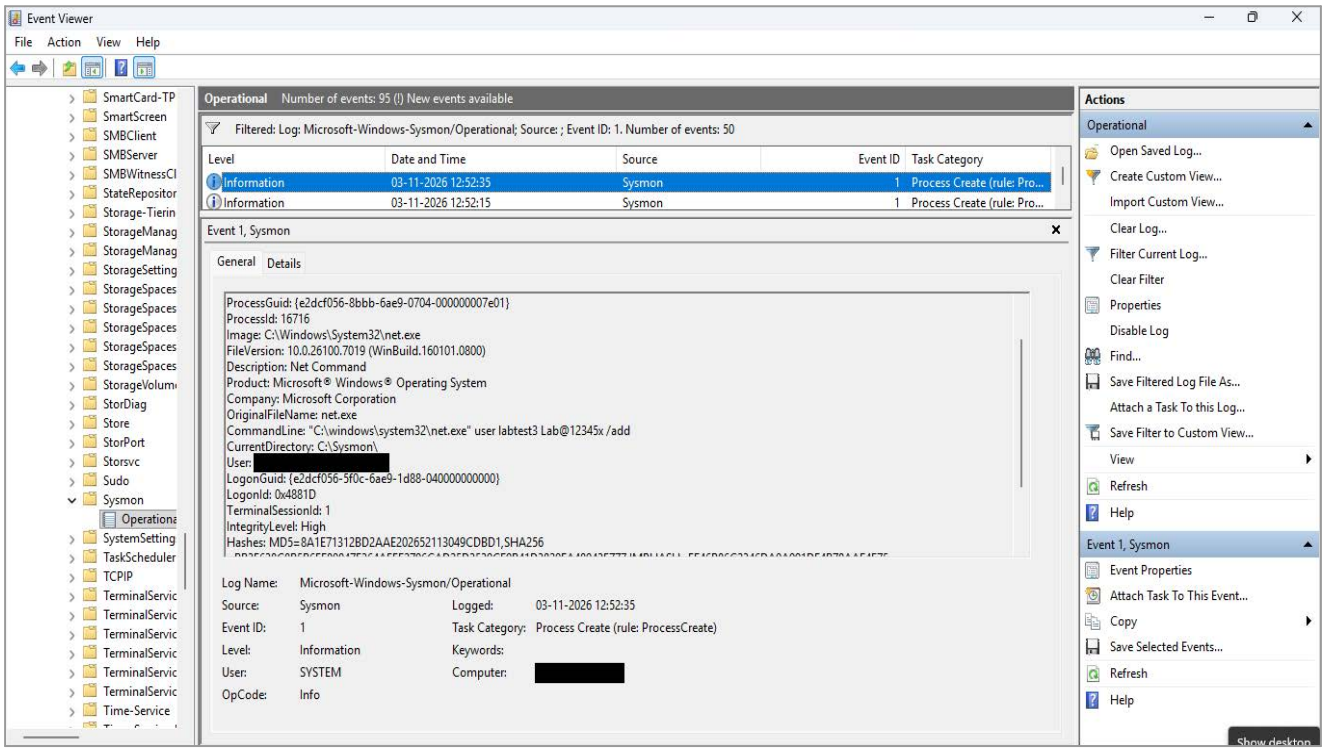
Action	I opened a new PowerShell window using the command Start-Process powershell.exe.
Event ID	1 (Process Create)
Timestamp	03-11-2026 12:52:15
Key fields	Image: C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe CommandLine: "C:\windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe" CurrentDirectory: C:\Sysmon\ User: (redacted)
Why it matters	PowerShell is one of the tools attackers use most often because it is already built into Windows (MITRE T1059.001). Sysmon records the full command line and the user, so an analyst can see exactly how it was started and spot suspicious options such as encoded or hidden commands.



Screenshot: Event 1 - Process Create (12:52:15)

2. Creating a new user account

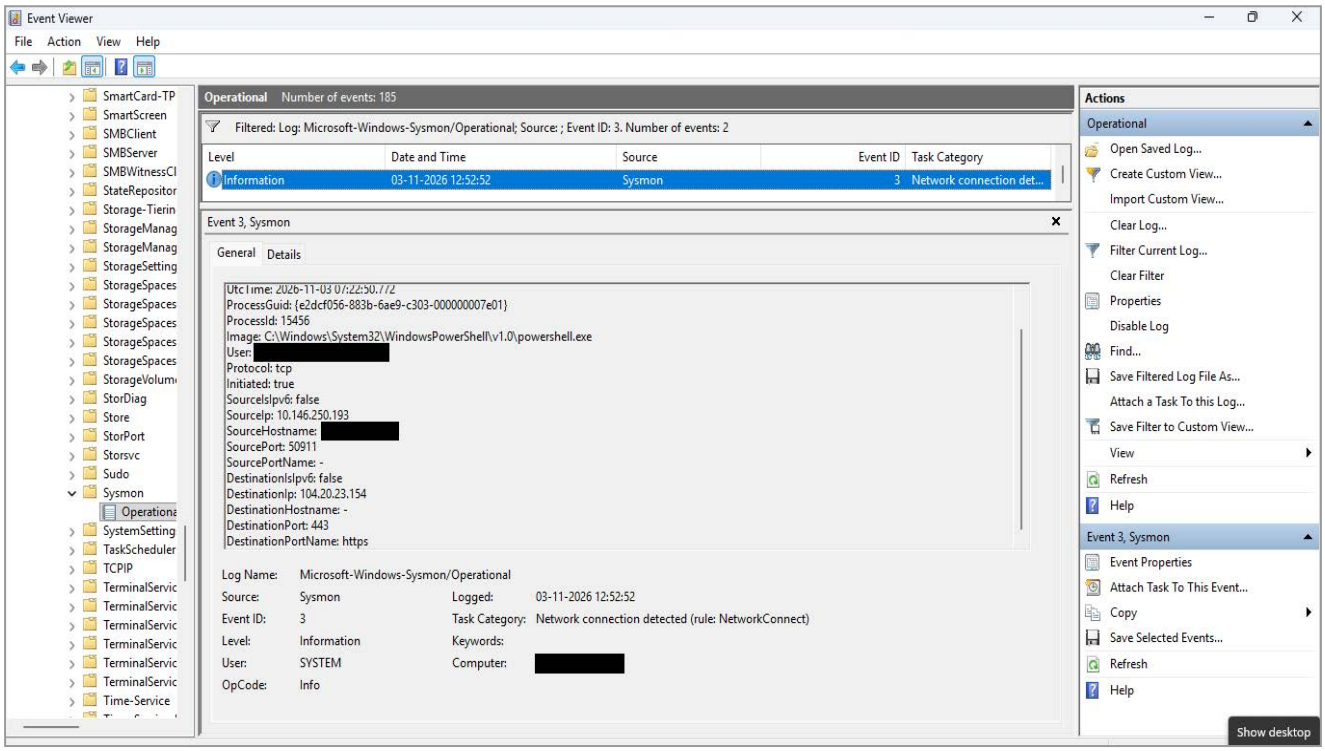
Action	I created a dummy local account with: net user labtest3 Lab@12345x /add. I deleted it after taking the screenshots.
Event ID	1 (Process Create)
Timestamp	03-11-2026 12:52:35
Key fields	Image: C:\Windows\System32\net.exe (followed by net1.exe) CommandLine: net user labtest3 Lab@12345x /add IntegrityLevel: High User: (redacted)
Why it matters	Creating a new account is a common way for an attacker to keep access (MITRE T1136.001). The command line shows the account name and the password that was used, which gives more detail than Security Event 4720 alone.



Screenshot: Event 1 - Process Create (12:52:35)

3. Checking network connections

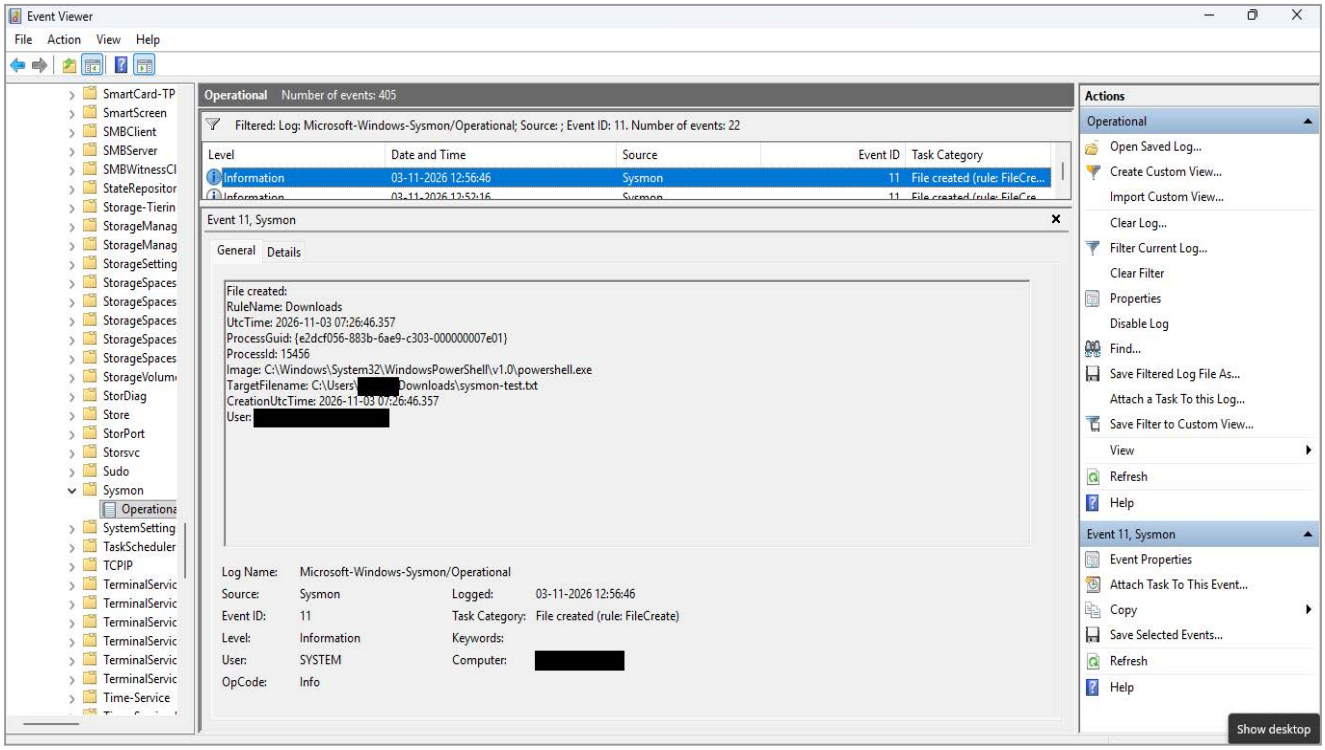
Action	I made a web request from PowerShell with Invoke-WebRequest to https://example.com, then ran netstat -ano.
Event ID	3 (Network Connection)
Timestamp	03-11-2026 12:52:52
Key fields	Image: powershell.exe Protocol: tcp, Initiated: true SourceIp: 10.146.250.193, SourcePort: 50911 DestinationIp: 104.20.23.154, DestinationPort: 443 (https)
Why it matters	This event ties a network connection to the exact process that made it. It helps an analyst detect command-and-control traffic, data exfiltration and lateral movement, especially when a process like PowerShell connects to an unknown address.



Screenshot: Event 3 - Network Connection (12:52:52)

4. Creating a text file

Action	I created a text file named sysmon-test.txt in my Downloads folder using PowerShell. I deleted it afterwards.
Event ID	11 (File Create)
Timestamp	03-11-2026 12:56:46
Key fields	Image: powershell.exe TargetFilename: C:\Users\(redacted)\Downloads\sysmon-test.txt RuleName: Downloads CreationUtcTime: 2026-11-03 07:26:46.357
Why it matters	It shows which process created a file and where. Files dropped in folders such as Downloads, Temp or Startup are a common sign of malware being delivered or of persistence being set up.



Screenshot: Event 11 - File Create (12:56:46)

Additional Observations

• Running netstat -ano was also logged as its own Event ID 1 (NETSTAT.EXE) at 12:53:00.

• My first test file, created in the Temp folder, was not logged. The SwiftOnSecurity configuration only records file creation for certain file types and folders, so I created the file in Downloads, which matches its Downloads rule.

• The dummy account labtest3 and both test files were deleted after the screenshots were taken.